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Root Safety Strategies for Teens

**SHOUT NO!****RUN — TELL Someone**

If an adult asks you to do something that seems "weird," uncomfortable or confusing, leave the situation as soon as you can and tell a *safe adult* about it. Always remember that it is an adult's job to protect teens. If s/he is confused and breaks boundaries, it is never a teen's fault.

Shh..

KEEP and SPEAK Secrets

Confiding in someone means that you tell a person something that you trust them not to misuse. Typically secrets shared are harmless, but sometimes secrets shared need to be told to an adult who can help.

KEEP Secrets are harmless. They don't make you feel uncomfortable, upset or confused. An example may be if a friend confides who s/he has a crush on.

SPEAK Secrets are harmful and unsafe. These types of secrets need to be told to a *safe adult*. An example may be a secret about someone who is in trouble or may need some help. A secret about abuse, harassment, danger, or illegal activity needs to be told to an adult who can help.

**Buddy System**

There is truth to the phrase, "There is safety in numbers." Always bringing someone along when you are going places will reduce the risk of something harmful happening to you.

**Trust Your INSTINCTS**

Pay attention to how you feel in situations. Notice if you are uncomfortable in a situation or by what someone is doing. Your instincts are the feelings inside of you that warn you something isn't quite right and possibly unsafe. Listen wisely!

**DIGNITY and RESPECT**

All people deserve to be treated with dignity and respect. Everybody is equal regardless of where they come from, or the experiences they have endured. Recognize your own self-worth and expect to be treated well.

**If asked to go and your parents don't know, SHOUT NO!**

Always have permission from parents/guardians before going anywhere. It is a parent's/guardian's job to protect and monitor teens. Knowing where teens are increases their safety as adults can intervene more quickly if they need help.

**If asked to share and your parents aren't aware, SAY NO!**

It is important to protect your personal information. People can misuse personal information to harm or embarrass others. If someone asks you for personal/private information and you do not know them well, they are breaking boundaries. Make sure to talk to a *safe adult* about individuals who are breaking boundaries.